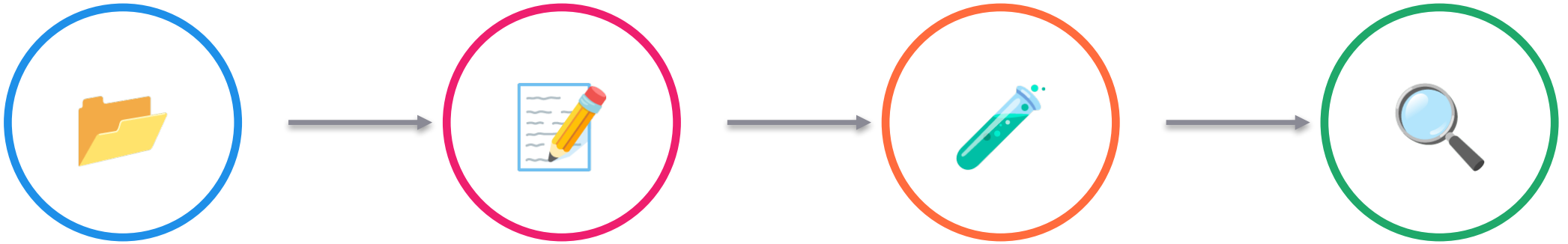
Team Rules for OpenAI Codex with AGENTS.md



Akmal Khan
Senior Full Stack AI Architect
akmalkhaniub.github.io

Author Audition

Meet Codex: OpenAI’s coding agent



Reads your repo

Writes the change

Runs your tests

You review the diff

Give it a task in plain English. It works in your repo like a teammate.

Codex app · CLI · IDE extension. Today: the Codex app on Windows.

Author Audition

Overview



Your smartest teammate forgets everything between tasks.

🤖 Codex memory

your team’s rules

Task done. Memory: empty.

WHAT'S IN IT FOR YOU

Stop leaving the same review comments on Codex’s code.

1 The problem → 2 The fix → 3 The proof

Codex wrote this. Spot the problem.

shop/pricing.py

```
def apply_coupon(total, code):
    """Apply SAVE10 and round to cents."""
    if code != "SAVE10":
        raise ValueError("Invalid coupon")
    return (total * Decimal("0.90")).quantize(CENT)
```

Files changed: shop/pricing.py, tests/test_pricing.py

Add an Example: to the docstring

Use AppError, not ValueError

You forgot CHANGELOG.md

🤔 **What would your reviewer say?**

Why? Every task starts with an empty head.



Task 1: coupons



Task 2: gift cards

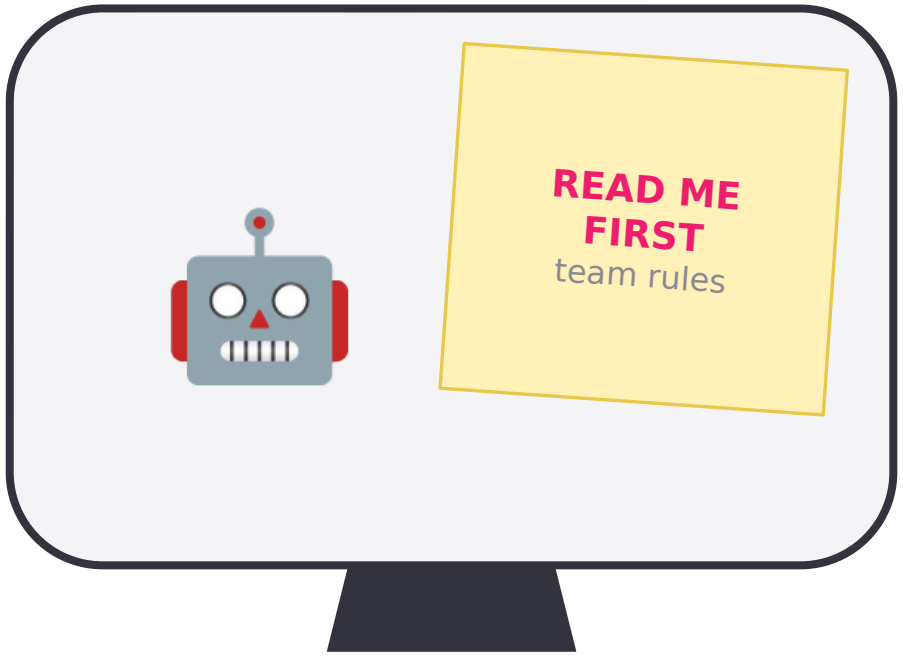


Task 3: refunds

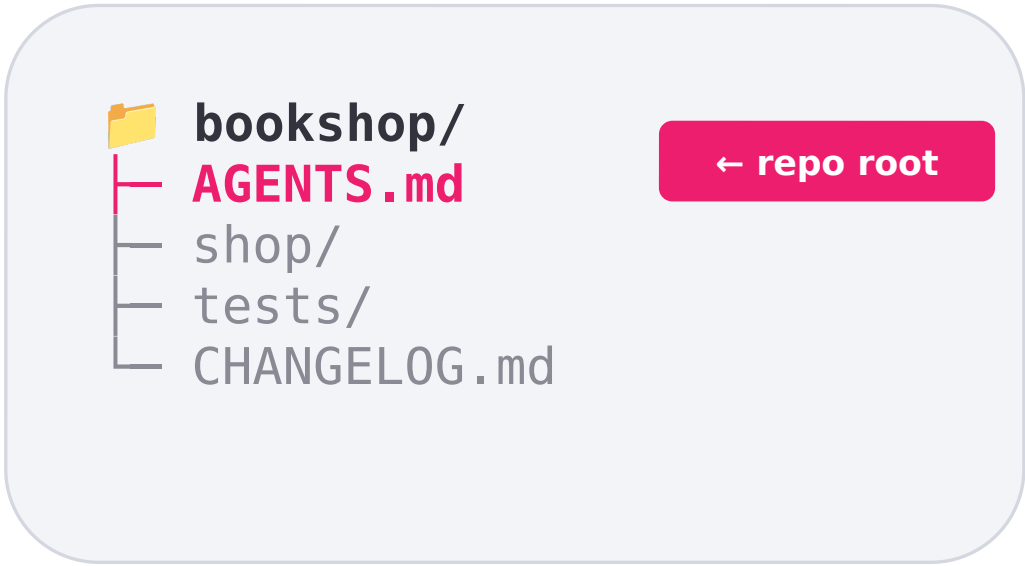
Where your team’s rules live today:

- 🧠 **People’s heads**
- 📄 **Onboarding docs**
- 💬 **Old review threads**
- **✗ Not where Codex looks**

The fix: leave a note where Codex looks first







📖 **Codex reads it before every task**

👥 **Committed in Git: one note for the whole team**

🔄 **Edited it? Start a new thread**

Your review comments ARE the note

FROM THE REVIEW

Add an Example: to the docstring

Use AppError, not ValueError

You forgot CHANGELOG.md

📝 **AGENTS.md**

```
- Public functions: docstring with an
Example: line.

- Invalid input: raise AppError with an
UPPER_SNAKE code.

- Add one line to CHANGELOG.md under ##
Unreleased.

- Before finishing, run the tests: python -m
unittest
```

Write each comment once, as a rule a reviewer could check in the diff.

Demo



Same prompt.

Without the note, then with it.

1. **No note: ask Codex to add apply_coupon**
2. **Review the diff: do the stickers come back?**
3. **Add AGENTS.md, new thread, same prompt**
4. **Compare the two diffs**

Same prompt. One file. Zero comments.

Without the note

```
def apply_coupon(total, code):
    """Apply SAVE10."""
    if code != "SAVE10":
        raise ValueError(...)
    return ...
```

✗ Add an Example: to the docstring

✗ Use AppError, not ValueError

✗ You forgot CHANGELOG.md

With AGENTS.md

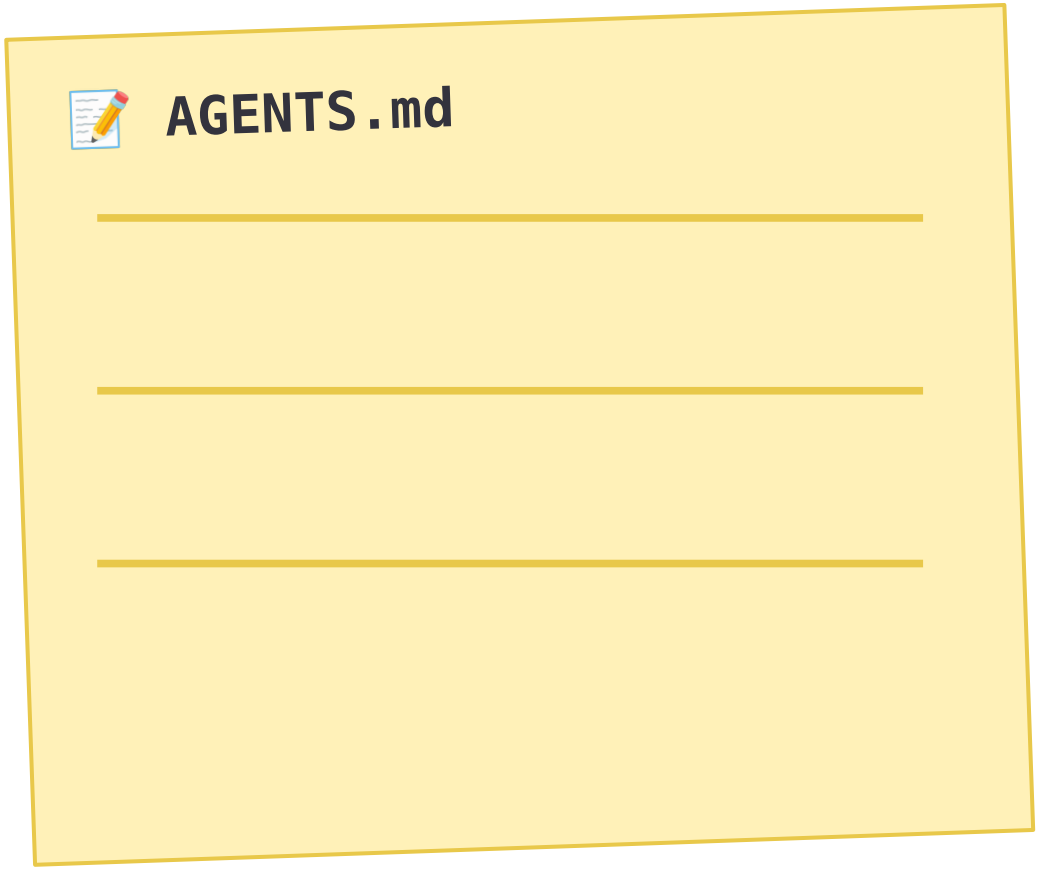
```
def apply_coupon(total, code):
    """... Example: apply_coupon(...)"""
    if code != "SAVE10":
        raise AppError("INVALID_COUPON", ...)
    return ...
```

✓ Example: line in the docstring

✓ AppError with a code

✓ CHANGELOG.md updated

Your turn: what’s on your team’s note?



💬 **The review comment you type most**

💻 **The command everyone forgets to run**

📄 **The file nobody remembers to update**

Summary



Codex starts every task fresh

AGENTS.md is the note it reads first

Review comments become rules

Rules guide Codex. You still review